

txt2latex(1)

User Command

16 May 2026

NAME

txt2latex - convert flat ASCII text to L^AT_EX.

SYNOPSIS

txt2latex [*OPTION...*] *FILE*

DESCRIPTION

txt2latex converts the input text into L^AT_EX.

txt2latex is also able to recognize and format sections, paragraphs, lists (itemize, enumerate, description) and verbatim blocks.

If input file *FILE* is omitted, standard input is used. Result is displayed on standard output.

Here is how text patterns are recognized and processed:

Sections These headers are defined by a line in upper case, starting column 1. Optionally, the Section name can be preceded by a blank line. This is useful for a better visualization of the source text to be used to generate the L^AT_EXsource code.

Paragraphs They must be separated by a blank line, and left aligned. Alternatively two blank spaces can be used to produce the same result. This option will provide a better visualization of the source text to be used to generate the L^AT_EXsource code.

Description list The item definition is separated from the item description by at least 2 blank spaces, even before a new line, if definition is too long.

Bullet list Bullet list items are defined by the first word being ”-”, ”*” or ”o”.

Enumerated list The first word must be a number followed by a dot or a rounded bracket.

Verbatim blocks This paragraph type is used to display unmodified text, for example source code. It must be separated by a blank line and be indented by a TAB. It is primarily used to format unmodified source code. It will be printed using verbatim environment.

Mathematics Inline mathematics must be enclosed with a simple \$ sign and equations must be enclosed with double \$ signs.

OPTIONS

-v, --version Display version.

-h, --help Display help.

-d date Set date. Defaults to current date.

-t mytitle Set the title. If the title is set, txt2latex will automatically add the preamble and markups for the document

- a author** Set the author.
- s shift** Shift heading level by 0 (section), 1 (subsection), or 2 (subsection). Defaults to 0.
- I txt** Italicize txt in output. Can be specified more than once.
- B txt** Emphasize (bold) txt in output. Can be specified more than once.
- P package** Add packages or LaTeX commands in the preamble.
- X** Compile output with pdflatex.

NOTES

The formatting rules are heavily inspired from `txt2man(1)`. The special treatment for sections NAME and SYNOPSIS performed automatically by `txt2man(1)` is not done by **txt2latex**. Nonetheless, the objective of **txt2latex** is not to parse on man-formatted plain text but to convert any plain text to $\LaTeX$.

Using the options `-B` and `-I`, you can easily format your text as it would be done by `txt2man`.

EXAMPLES

Simple conversion

```
$ txt2latex FILE > FILE.tex
```

Conversion with document title

```
$ txt2latex -t "title" -a "author" -I "word" FILE > FILE.tex
```

Conversion with custom packages and direct rendering with pdflatex

```
$ txt2latex -t "title" -a "author" -I "word" -P "\\usepackage{ccfonts}" -X FILE
```

SEE ALSO

`txt2man(1)`